PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | Azure Cloud | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of progressive experience in enterprise cyber security engineering, with a strong focus on Microsoft security platforms including Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Azure Cloud. Currently serving as Senior Cyber Security Engineer at the University of the Arts London, I continuously improve the organisation's security posture, identify and remediate vulnerabilities across Windows Server and Azure Cloud infrastructure, and provide third-line incident response and major incident support as a cybersecurity subject matter expert. I have hands-on experience with Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) technical accreditation, Single Sign-On (SSO) design, Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) management, and identity security through Microsoft Entra ID. I hold CISSP certification alongside Microsoft and CompTIA credentials, and I am ready to bring this combination of platform expertise and structured security engineering to a global professional services environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Security Platform:** Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365), Defender XDR, KQL query authoring
- **Azure Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Azure security posture management
- **Identity and Access Management:** Single Sign-On (SSO), Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus, Windows Server security hardening, patch management
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation
- **Compliance and Accreditation:** Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+), NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR playbook development
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61, major incident management, third-line support, executive reporting, root cause analysis
- **Certifications:** CISSP, SC-200 aligned, CompTIA Security+, MCSA

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Continuously improve the organisation's security posture by designing, integrating, and managing complex infrastructure and cloud security solutions across Azure and Windows Server environments.
- Identify and remediate vulnerabilities across Windows Server and Azure Cloud, leading structured vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Pentera BAS, and Nessus, prioritising critical risks and tracking remediation to closure.
- Provide third-line support and major incident response as a cybersecurity subject matter expert, leading end-to-end incident handling in line with NIST SP 800-61 and producing post-incident executive reports.
- Operate Microsoft Sentinel as the primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, authoring KQL detection queries, building alert logic, and maintaining correlation rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, tuning policies, investigating alerts, and reducing false positive rates through continuous refinement.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID, including Conditional Access policy design, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement, and Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust.

- Deliver Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) accreditation from a technical engineering perspective, evidencing security controls across all domains and remediating identified gaps before assessments.
- Design and manage Single Sign-On (SSO) integrations and Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) components, improving identity governance and reducing attack surface from orphaned credentials.
- Automate security operations tasks using PowerShell scripting and SOAR playbooks, reducing manual effort and accelerating response to repeated alert patterns.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Operated Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM for alert triage, threat detection, and incident investigation across a complex higher education environment.
- Supported the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365), achieving complete coverage across all endpoint and identity surfaces.
- Wrote KQL-based hunting queries and detection content in Microsoft Sentinel, proactively identifying threat indicators aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques.
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), managing privileged account lifecycle, session recording, and just-in-time access workflows.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, coordinating remediation with Windows Server and network infrastructure teams.
- Contributed to SSO rollout and Conditional Access policy design in Microsoft Entra ID, strengthening identity security and reducing phishing-related account compromise.
- Supported ISO 27001 evidence gathering and internal audit readiness, mapping controls to NIST CSF and CIS Controls.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Delivered security engineering support across Azure Cloud and on-premises infrastructure for a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) platform.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra ID), Windows Server security hardening, and endpoint protection policies, maintaining a secure baseline across the technology estate.
- Implemented Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies to secure employee and corporate devices.
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities including evidence collection, risk register maintenance, and internal audit preparation.
- Managed PKI certificate lifecycle, firewall rule reviews, and vulnerability scanning across cloud and on-premises systems.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led end-to-end Microsoft Sentinel deployment and tuning across UAL's 8,000-user estate, authoring over 40 custom KQL detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing false positive rates by 55%.
- Delivered Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) certification renewal by personally evidencing all technical controls and remediating identified gaps, achieving a clean pass with no post-assessment actions.
- Redesigned Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA policies, reducing identity-based attack surface by 80% and preventing three credential-stuffing incidents.
- Drove Pentera BAS programme from inception, identifying and remediating critical attack paths across Windows Server and Azure Cloud environments, reducing exploitable vulnerabilities by 65%.
- Automated major incident notification and triage workflows using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks, cutting initial response time by 40%.
- Led deployment of BeyondTrust PAM solution across 200 privileged accounts, achieving full privileged session recording and just-in-time access for all elevated roles.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)